

GOAL AT RISK

Hoping is not a plan.

What to do when the goal slips halfway through.

AND THE CONSEQUENCE

Either the math works at the real pace, or something has to change today.

THE CASCADE

The silence that costs the quarter.



WHAT YOU SEE

The team spots the gap weeks before you do...



THE MECHANISM

...everyone bets that next month makes up for it...



THE CONSEQUENCE

...and the real conversation happens when there is no time left.

| A goal lost in silence costs more than a goal renegotiated early.

THE FORK

Three possible reactions, only one works.

THREE REACTIONS

01

Squeezing whoever is already at the limit?
The math is unchanged.

02

Waiting for next month to save it? That is
a bet, not management.

03

Redoing the math at the real pace? That is
control coming back.

The pace of the last four weeks is the best predictor of the next four.

THE METHOD

The gap math, four lines.

01 **HOW MUCH IS MISSING**

the exact number still to happen, no rounding

02 **HOW MUCH TIME IS LEFT**

weeks left, minus holidays and vacations already booked

03 **WHAT PACE IT DEMANDS**

gap divided by weeks, compared with the current pace

04 **WHAT COMES OFF THE LIST**

what you stop doing so that pace can fit

Fifteen minutes with the team and a spreadsheet. Nothing more than that.

IN PRACTICE, IN ORDER

Four things to get right in the talk.

01 • HOW MUCH
IS MISSING

Own your part first.

what you did not decide or did not remove in time

02 • HOW MUCH
TIME IS LEFT

Show the math, not the conclusion.

the team accepts a number it can check for itself

03 • WHAT PACE
IT DEMANDS

Say what comes off, not only what stays.

a goal recalibrated with no cut is the same goal renamed

04 • WHAT COMES
OFF THE LIST

Tell your leadership before they ask.

whoever warns early negotiates, whoever warns late explains

TWO MODELS

Pushing or recalibrating.

THE COMMON MODEL

Pushing

Repeats the goal louder

Asks the same team for more effort

Keeps everything on the list

Communicates in the final week

THE DESIGNED MODEL

Recalibrating

Redoes the math with real data

Changes the plan, not the speech

Cuts what does not fit

Communicates as soon as the math breaks

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three reflexes that deepen the hole.

01 Hunting for a culprit before a cause.

- the team stops raising problems, and the next gap arrives silent.
-

02 Lowering the goal with no explanation of the criteria.

- a goal that moves with no math loses whatever credibility is left.
-

03 Adding more control instead of more focus.

- a new report produces no result, it only eats the week.
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Whoever only shows up at the gap teaches the team to hide the gap.

THE CHAIN

The honest math test.

01

Multiply the real pace by the weeks that remain.



02

It does not get there even in the best case?



03

Then saying it will land is not confidence, it is hope.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

The math does not argue with you. That is why it is your best ally in the room.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

Thirty minutes to take control back.

▣ STEP 01 Run the four lines of the math before any meeting. the gap, the time, the pace required and what comes off the list	▣ STEP 02 Choose what stops now to free up capacity. with no cut, the replan is just a motivational speech	■ STEP 03 Warn whoever depends on the result, with the plan in hand. bringing a problem with a plan protects your credibility
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Replanning early is mature focus, not a lack of grit.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The Gap Math, in the order that matters.



A goal at risk does not need another speech.
It needs math on the table and a cut on the list.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER
next time the goal starts to slip.

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